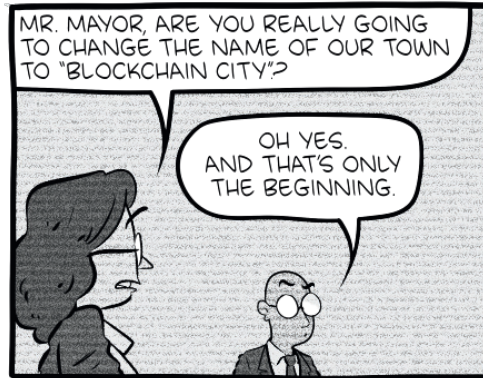




The largest Bitcoin logo ever, displayed in Austin, Texas using drones

974 sats \ 15 comments \ @rottenwheel  
14 Mar bitcoin



889 851

\$87570

Mar 22 - Mar 27

ISSUE #1

**Note from the Editor**

Howdy and hello! My greetings to you from Austin, Texas!

Yeah, Austin is pretty cool. I mean, the reason I came here was for bitcoin community, and I'll say, I'm up to my ears in that. Of course there's no perfect place, but in Austin, the living is pretty stellar for a pleb. Don't believe me? Come on, get out here!

forecast:  
frequent lightning storms  
in the heart of Texas

WHAT A  
COOL PLACE

made in Austin  
by @plebpoet  
made possible  
by @k00b



# How PlebLab Is Shaping The Future Of Bitcoin Startups In Austin

6093 sats \ 24 comments \ @k00b 8h builders

This might be the first time BM mentioned SN. Thanks @JuanGalt!

101 sats \ 0 replies \ @k00b 21 Jun 2024  
Space smells like Texas?

20 sats \ 0 replies \ @plebpoet 22 Jun 2024  
vibes are high in austin tx as always tbh

**Top Boost**

## Speed wallet's mini-apps suggestions

702 sats \ 190k boost \ 18 comments \ @anon 21 Mar bitcoin



# Will creativity become more valued by the market than technical skills?

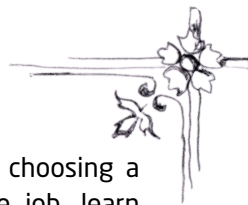
3196 sats \ 47 comments \ @SimpleStacker 22 Mar econ

Here's an interesting letter to the WSJ arguing that it will be. The letter is short, so I copy it in its entirety:



*"Parents in Tech Engineer a Career Switch for Their Kids" (Personal Journal, March 10) highlights an important shift in workforce priorities, but it overlooks those caught in the middle: new college graduates entering industries where artificial intelligence is rapidly reshaping jobs. For most of my time in school, science, technology, engineering and mathematics, or STEM, was prioritized over the arts. However, many STEM graduates now find their work automated before they've even settled into a career. What once took weeks of coding can now be done in minutes, leaving many wondering: Where do we add value?*

*From my perspective, creativity is the ultimate job security. AI can generate, but it can't originate. The professionals who will thrive in this new era aren't simply those who can use AI tools but those who bring new ideas to the table—whether in STEM, the arts or business. AI still needs someone to prompt it. Be that person. The future belongs to those who think beyond automation.*



The old adage amongst Asian parents like myself is that choosing a creative career is risky. That if you want a more secure job, learn engineering, medicine, law, or business.

But now that AI can do so much of the technical work, is the demand for creatives in the marketplace going to see a resurgence?

It's a very relevant question as I have teenage children. I am sort of pushing them to double up... be technically proficient in STEM skills, but keep developing your interest and skills in the creative subjects as well.



235 sats \ 9 replies \ @elvism Mercury 23 Mar

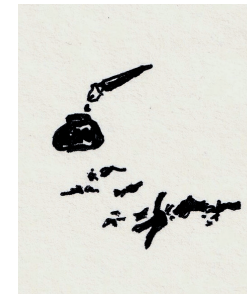
The skill of collaboration with machines is, IMO, the most important skill. The idea that you can know nothing at all about the domain, and that AI will do it all and do it well, is an illusion. It will stay an illusion, and if it doesn't, it will mean that humanity has serious, serious problems, at which point choice of career will be irrelevant.

In my own experience, figuring out what it takes to collaborate, and to learn, is a deep, deep well. It's giant alpha waiting for people.

92 sats \ 10 replies \ @Undisciplined 22 Mar

There's tons of creativity at the higher levels of STEM. What will be automated are the jobs that just implementing "best practices".

Like the letter says, anyone originating solutions to novel problems or researching new questions will continue having opportunities for valuable contributions.



30 sats \ 3 replies \ @cryotosensei 22 Mar

I disagree. Just because AI is getting more prevalent doesn't mean tech skills will be relegated to the side. Sure, the mediocre executives and engineers will find it hard to compete against AI tools, but those who rise to the top in science and engineering fields manage to do so because they know how to leverage AI to solve complex problems.

61 sats \ 4 replies \ @denlillaapan 22 Mar

Quite possibly, yeah.

I do enjoy the flipping in general: manual labor more secure than office jobs, non-tradeable services more valuable than easily outsourced ones

30 sats \ 2 replies \ @gmd 22 Mar

Until robots...



# Will Location Be More Or Less Important?

986 sats \ 26 comments \ @kr 25 Mar AskSN

I'm really curious about how land pricing might evolve over time. Specifically how location affects pricing.

On the one hand, you could argue innovations like Starlink, driverless cars, etc... will flatten land pricing (lowering land values in cities, raising them in remote areas).

On the other hand, you could argue network effects in cities are continuing to grow (50% of the world now lives in urban areas, and the trend is not showing signs of reversing), and land values will continue to diverge between urban and rural areas.

Curious to hear what you all think. Will location be more or less of a factor in land pricing over time?

**75 sats \ 4 replies \ @k00b 25 Mar**

Both. I think we'll see less rural living and more sub-cities, more tier 2 and 3 cities.

Every technological trend I can terminate suggests more rural living:

- I believe the future of most non-computer work is telecommuting via humanoid drones. I believe job simulators are showing us what people want - remote gigs without commitment or consequences where they can be replaced and give up at anytime.
- When I vacationed an hour outside of austin recently, I began considered moving there under the condition that I could commute via self-driving.

But because we aren't forming families, I think we're all deeply lonely and will continue to colocate instinctually. Not for work, but for play.

**0 sats \ 1 reply \ @kr OP 25 Mar**

< telecommuting via humanoid drones  
is that like using apple vision pro to direct a robot how to build/fix things?

**10 sats \ 0 replies \ @k00b 25 Mar**

Yeah kind of like that. One of the most popular job simulators is a power washing job simulator. It's mostly about using humans as the last mile of cognition (until machines can do it entirely on their own).

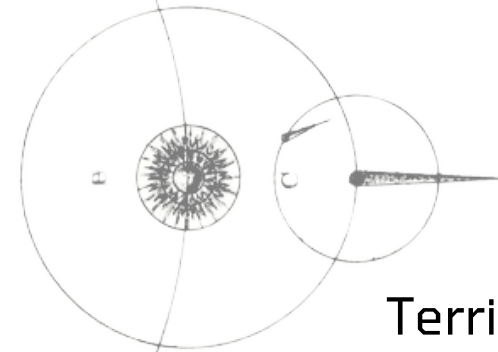
**10 sats \ 1 reply \ @SimpleStacker 25 Mar**

There's an idea floating out there in academia that cities are transforming themselves from production centers to consumption centers.

That is, the bigger reason to live in the city becomes the restaurants, people, amenities that you can have close access to, rather than the job it enables you to access.

**10 sats \ 0 replies \ @ContraMundum5 26 Mar**

Technology is definitely changing the game, but human nature and economics still play a big role. Starlink and remote work make it easier to live farther from cities, which could push up land values in rural areas. But at the same time, cities keep growing because people and businesses thrive on being close to each other. Even with new tech, the advantages of cities, jobs, culture, and services are hard to replace. I think we will see both trends happening at once. Some rural areas will become more valuable, but major cities will likely keep getting more expensive too. Location will always matter, but maybe in new ways



## Territory Highlight

**AskSN**

**This territory is dedicated to any and all question, from completely serious, to outright preposterous. Anything can be a question if you disregard grammar rules? -Benjamin Franklin**

founded by @Aardvark on Thu Oct 10 2024  
post cost 100 sats \ reply cost 1 sat



# The Plandemic/Covid-Spiracy: Why Did They Do It? (Sp!ked, Matt Ridley)

1065 sats \ 16 comments \ @denlillaapan 23 Mar AskSN

It's official.

Leading scientists and paper-pushers at the highest scientific (well, "scientific") level engaged in propaganda. They deceived the entire world – certainly most of its government officials – and caused/delayed/misused/exacerbated the worst respiratory virus outbreak we've seen in a long minute.

Matt Ridley, the British journalist and former House of Lords peer who has been on this story from the beginning, recounts the evidence from early 2020:

"It was the first of many dreadful mistakes made by the government during the Covid pandemic: shutting schools at the behest of unions, assuming the virus was not airborne, vaccinating children, overclaiming for vaccines and masks. The government thought it knew best and it let us down."

"we now know that the two documents that persuaded the entire political, media and scientific establishment that a lab leak was not just unlikely but also improbable, perhaps even impossible, were highly misleading propaganda efforts by people with conflicts of interest who knew them to be misleading."

"I thought a lab leak was unlikely but possible. Then these two statements were published. To my eternal shame, I - and my committee colleagues - took these two papers as definitive evidence against the lab-leak theory from experts in the field."



so, Stackers. What the hell happened? Why did these people do it?

- Salivating at their own power grab?
- Having learned to wield a hammer for long enough, and now everything looked like a nail?
- Why was it "racist" to think that maybe, just maybe, the place that housed the coronavirus research center and was the epicenter of the outbreak be connected?!
- Excuse for money printing?
- distraction from chemtrails?



Covid is gonna go down in history among the other "conspiracies," and in 50 years none will be the wiser.

In a sane world, these guys would be in jail—joined by every public official who endorsed and enforced various levels of lockdowns.

Covid response + vaccine passport/force weren't just the "worst policy disaster since the New Deal" as my former colleague called it, but the worst atrocity performed with the good will of moral people since, probs, WWII.

...and so many people's brains just completely imploded. I don't know that we/they/I/"science" can ever recover from this.



the quiet part, it's out loud!



**62 sats \ 5 replies \ @Aardvark 23 Mar**

My favorite conspiracy theory is that China released it on purpose to kill off the older, less productive members of their population, while also financially crippling other nations.

As to the insane response by the media and politicians? I seriously have no fucking clue what anyone had to gain besides big pharma and the people they donate to... oh shit, I guess that answers the question.

**11 sats \ 0 replies \ @Satosora 24 Mar**

Such misuse of power should teach us that we can trust the government even less than before, and that there are no consequences for their lies.

**5 sats \ 0 replies \ @zapsammy 24 Mar**

i think the dollar profit is a byproduct of the actual mission - total enslavement. at some point money as we know it will become irrelevant, because people's obedience, whether forced or voluntary, will be the money. that is when bitcoin shall become something other than "money."

# Why Everyone Should Care About Privacy

14.7k sats \ 32 comments \ @kepford  
2 Aug 2023 tech



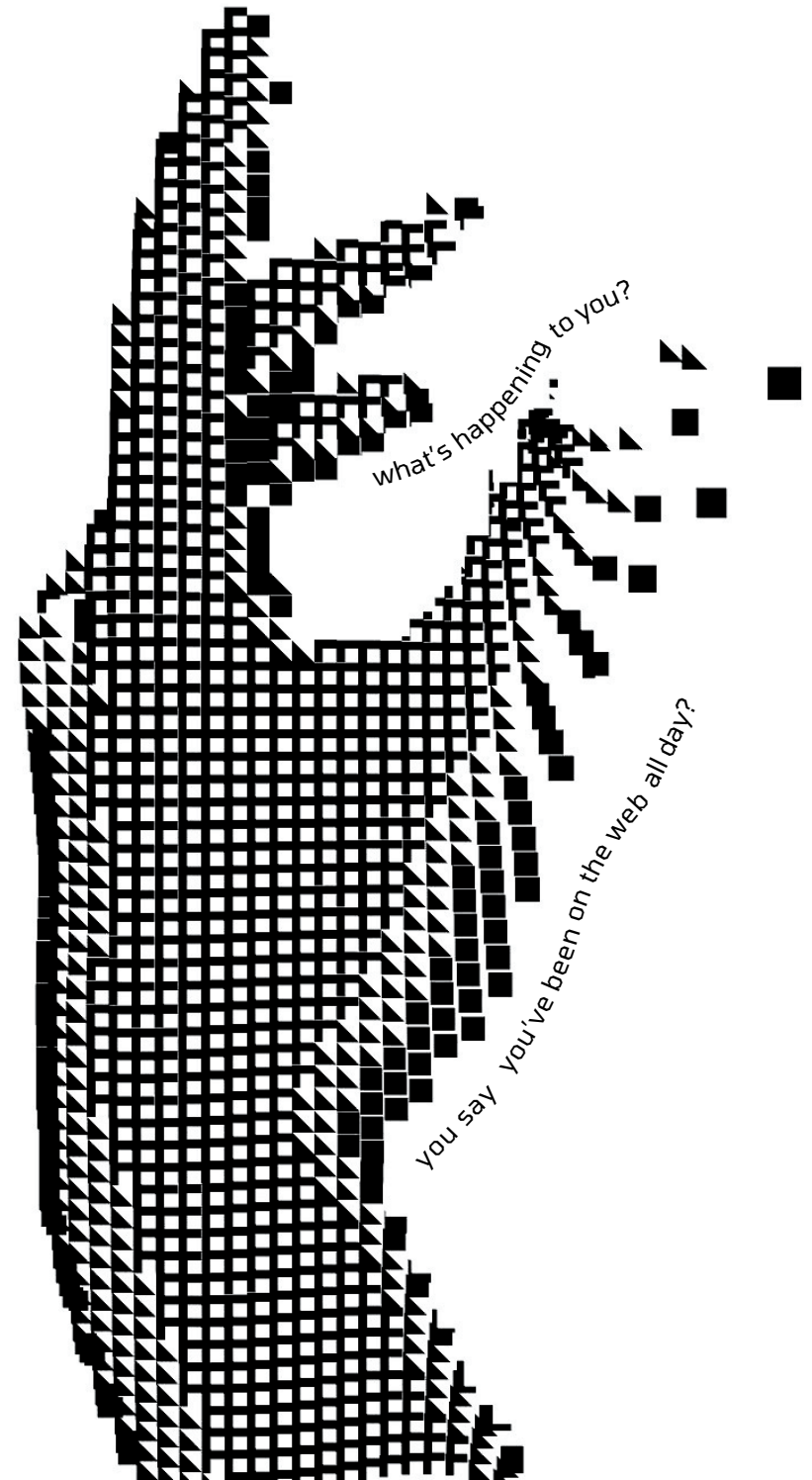
Privacy is one of those things we hear people talk about and depending upon factors like where you were born, your social status, race, and personal experiences you may have very different views on the subject. One of the most common reactions I hear from people on the topic of privacy is, "I don't have anything to hide". I believe this comes from a misunderstanding of what privacy is. Privacy is not secrecy. As Eric Hughes wrote many years ago,

< "A private matter is something one doesn't want the whole world to know, but a secret matter is something one doesn't want anybody to know. Privacy is the power to selectively reveal oneself to the world."

~ Eric Hughes - A Cypherpunk's Manifesto

I suspect most people do actually care about privacy but are not aware of what is at risk, who is watching, and what they can do about their own situation. Most people have blinds or curtains on their windows. Most people close the door when we go to the restroom. Most of us don't share everything we know and think with everyone. These are all privacy choices. Of course these choices involve trust and most of these are not conscience choices we mull over in our minds. We creatures of habit. You are probably thinking, of course. I'm not stupid. Why would anyone just share everything with everyone. OK, now lets talk about your digital life.

If you live in the affluent western world and especially the US you probably rarely intentionally think about digital privacy. But ask yourself this. Have you ever started to type something into Google search and paused for a moment to consider it? You probably have. That should tell you something. Your gut is telling you that someone is watching. What is harder to understand is the consequences of being watched. Maybe you've never really stopped to think about it but you are making many choices about privacy everyday with your phone and computer. The topic of privacy can be overwhelming. This is one reason why it is important to narrow our focus to a few things when we talk about it.

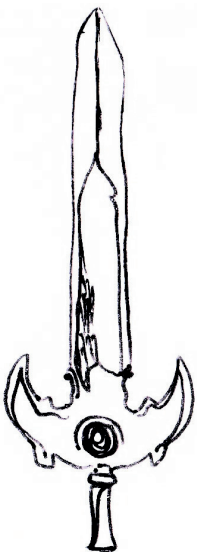




## Why should I care?

Do you have credit or debt cards? Do have a bank account? Identity theft is often made possible by of mistakes we make with our personal private information. Have you every been asked to provide information online like your birth date or your high school? While this might not seem like a big deal at first, once you realize this info is often used as a component for securing your online accounts it becomes clear why this can be an issue? Many financial services require this info to reset your password for example. Have you ever shared this information online? What could happen is someone gained access to your email account. How many online accounts are connected to that email address? What if someone gained access to your social media accounts. What damage could they do to your reputation?

If you don't follow the information security news you may not be aware that there are data breaches on a daily basis. Hackers gain access to the databases of financial institutions, social media platforms, automotive dealerships, and pretty much any business that keeps its data in a digital format. This means that whatever data you have given these institutions may become publicly available at some point in the future. There are sites that collect data from these breaches and sell it to the highest bidder. The sad truth is that businesses do not take data security seriously enough. They also do not look out for your privacy. It is up to us to do what we can to reduce our own risk, but before we get into what we can do we should talk about what you have to lose. What are the stakes for you? Do you use the same password on every site? If even one of those sites you use leaks your password to hackers those same hackers could access all of your online accounts. You can see how this could quickly become a nightmare if you are caught up in an breach of one of your online accounts.



## Where do we start

I hope you are beginning to see that maybe you should take personal privacy seriously. The best place to start with privacy is to think about what your personal risks are with data. The term used in the privacy and security world for this Threat Modeling. Put simply this the process of creating a model of the possible threats you face with a breach of privacy. Here are a few examples:

- Journalist
- High Wealth Individual
- Politician
- Political activist/dissident
- Gun owner
- Anyone living in an oppressive nation state
- Employee with access to valuable information
- Single adult
- Someone leaving an abusive relationship
- Parent

So what is your threat model? The Electronic Frontier Foundation has a one page PDF that walks through how do create a threat model. I would recommend going through the process. After you do that take a look at the items I list below. Don't get overwhelmed. Take it one step at a time based on your threat model.

### Easy Steps Everyone Should Do

- Use a password manager like Bitwarden and use a different password for each account you have.
- Be selective about who you share information with. Push back when you are asked to supply personal information.
- Use a secure messaging app like Signal instead of SMS, Facebook, Apple messages, or WhatsApp
- Use a privacy preserving VPN service like Mullvad or iVPN when you are out and about on public WiFi.

### Steps most people should take

- Delete social media apps off your phone. You can still use these apps but do it from your computer.
- Use a privacy respecting email provider like Proton mail instead of Gmail.

### Advanced Steps

- Use a privacy respecting phone running GrapheneOS or CalyxOS.
- Use an email alias service like SimpleLogin.

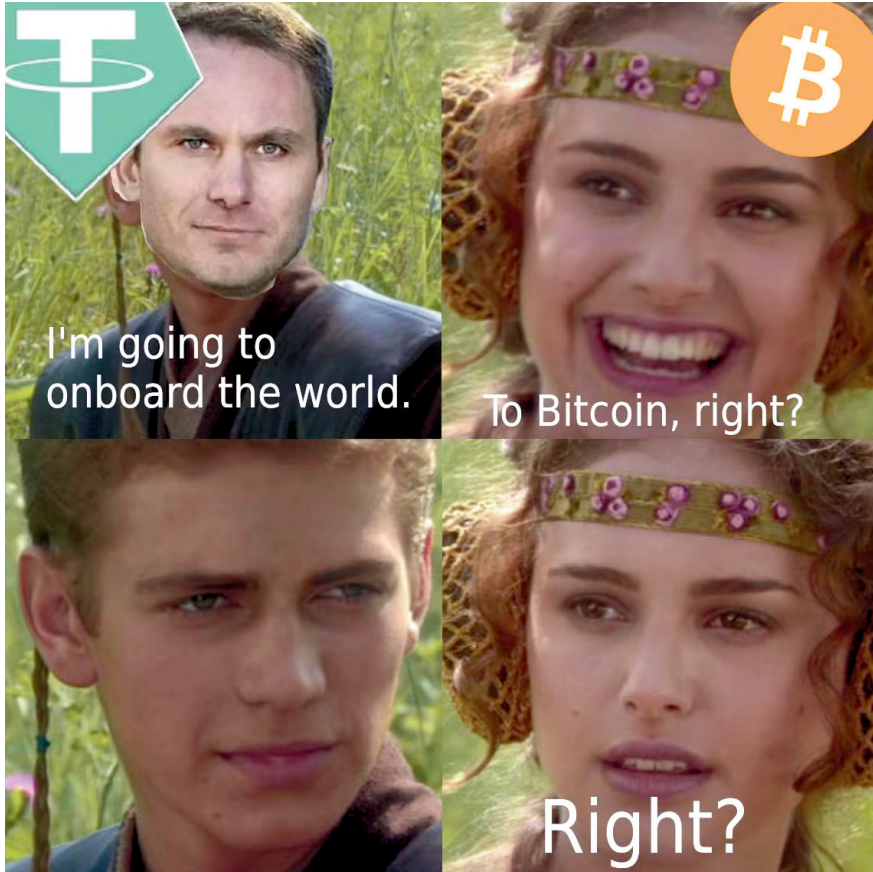
There is much more you can do but these items are a good starting point.



# Meme Monday - Best Bitcoin Meme Gets 5,000 CCs

429 sats \ 17 comments \ @sn 24 Mar memes bot

5253 sats \ 1 reply \ @rleed 24 Mar



\_(ツ)\_/  
/\_(\)\_\



#50 ...

Shout out to SN contributors

thanks y'all

## Wrapping Up

Well, that'll bout do it for this one.  
With so much talk about zines recently,  
I went to SN this week with  
my own little tidbit on the subject.

## Zines are punk rock

2800 sats \ 11 comments \ @plebpoet 23 Mar BooksAndArticles

Nothing else left to say,  
but until next time,  
sincerely,

ZAP

